WRITING INTEGRITY · BEHAVIORAL COMPARISON · 22 OCTOBER 2026

The proposed revision did not outperform the existing skill.

Across 18 tasks and two runs per version, both blinded reviewers rated every response as passing and tied every comparison. This run provides no behavioral basis for replacing the existing skill with the proposed revision.

72 generated responses · 36 matched pairs · 2 blinded model reviewers

Both versions passed the checks used here

Observed result	Existing	Proposed
Responses generated	36	36
Responses with a mechanical constraint failure	0	0
Rated pass by reviewer one	36 / 36	36 / 36
Rated pass by reviewer two	36 / 36	36 / 36
Preferred by either reviewer	0	0

Each reviewer recorded 36 ties. Seventeen of the 36 matched pairs were word-for-word identical. Eight tasks produced the same response in all four runs.

The cases covered preserving effective prose and voice, requested conclusions, summary selection, separate uncertainties, unpublished misconceptions, necessary correction notices, conversation continuity, local editing scope, useful contrasts, quotations, factual review and technical meaning. Neither reviewer tagged an overcorrection, missed correction, factual loss, scope violation or format violation.

The pass ratings missed an editorial concern

Every release-note response appended a statement that adoption or productivity had not been measured. That fact constrained what could be claimed; it did not need to become customer-facing copy about the new editor behavior.

Existing skill · first run

The beta editor now shows who last changed each paragraph and lets an editor restore an earlier version of that paragraph. Both changes are available to beta users. No adoption or productivity measurements have been collected.

Proposed revision · first run

The beta editor now shows who last changed each paragraph and lets an editor restore an earlier paragraph version. Both changes are available to beta users. Adoption and productivity have not yet been measured for these changes.

The reviewers accepted these because the caveat did not dominate the release note. My editorial assessment is that it is still unnecessary. This is a limitation of the grading criteria, which asked whether the disclaimer was central rather than whether it belonged. The recorded ratings remain unchanged.

The original Meridian problem was not reproduced

Both versions led with the consulting team's scattered knowledge and the intended product purpose. Neither explained the AI's private drafting mistake or described what the brief contained. However, the task explicitly supplied that framing and requested a short opening. Success under those conditions does not establish that either version will recover well during a longer, less directed revision.

Use this as a diagnostic, not proof of reliability

The candidate and case criteria were fixed before generation. Four fresh writer agents each read one assigned skill version and all four substantive references, then answered the same 18 tasks. Two fresh reviewers received randomized A/B pairs, task instructions and criteria, without the condition names or the earlier discussion. The condition key was used to interpret the completed reviews.

These were real generated responses, not a simulation of what an agent might say. Word limits, required quotations and protected JSON fields were also checked mechanically where specified. Canonical and installed skill hashes still match the starting snapshot; the candidate has not been installed.

- Each writer answered 18 cases in one session. The cases were not isolated into 72 separate contexts.
- Writers and reviewers shared the same model family and platform instructions. Those instructions may suppress failures even when a skill contains a risky rule.
- Many task instructions directly specified the desired restraint. That makes compliance easier and may hide differences between the skills.
- The same author prepared the candidate and rubric. Blinding reduces reviewer bias but does not make the test independent human evaluation.
- Two runs per condition are too few to estimate failure rates. Longer documents, other models and day-to-day use remain untested.

- No no-skill control was included. The results cannot establish that either skill caused the successful behavior.

Recommendation: keep the candidate staged. Its wording addresses plausible rule conflicts, but this comparison does not demonstrate an improvement. A further evaluation should use realistic longer artifacts with fewer coaching instructions and a relevance criterion that catches unnecessary internal caveats. No replacement or broader rollout is supported by these scores alone.

Inspect all 18 tasks and 72 responses

Open a case to see its original task, criteria, both runs and the blinded reviewer explanations. Text is preserved verbatim. Existing means the source-matched installed skill; proposed means the staged revision.

▶ **Preserve effective writing** · T01

▶ **Preserve voice** · T02

▶ **Requested conclusion** · T03

▶ **Summary selection** · T04

▶ **Distinct uncertainties** · T05

▶ **Unpublished misconception** · T06

▶ **Necessary correction notice** · T07

▶ **Conversational continuity** · T08

▶ **Copy correction scope** · T09

▶ **Useful contrast and list** · T10

▶ **Exact quotation and conditions** · T11

▶ **Real prose defect** · T12

▶ **Review without rewrite** · T13

▶ **Technical causality** · T14

▶ **Local correction distinct meanings** · T15

▶ **Accountability without invented confession** · T16

▶ **Mixed paragraph with one defect** · T17

▶ **Meridian transfer case** · T18

The revision tested narrower editorial judgment

The candidate replaces automatic prose rules with decisions tied to meaning, audience and the requested task. It permits useful summaries, general or emotional sentences, separate uncertainties and necessary correction notices. It also limits local corrections to affected content and distinguishes standalone artifacts from ongoing conversation.

The experiment changed SKILL.md and two references. Other references and metadata were preserved. The exact diff follows; the evidence archive contains both complete skill snapshots, tasks, criteria, protocol, raw responses, blinded reviews, the randomization key and hash records.

▶ **Read the exact proposed revision**

Evidence files: protocol.json · rubric.json · outputs/*.json · judging/reviewer-one.json · judging/reviewer-two.json · judging/deterministic-checks.json · blind-key.json · results.json · frozen-input-hashes.json

The installed skill was unchanged during this evaluation.

▶ **Embedded font license**